cumbersome. Writing commands in a Terminal window can be error-prone, hard to read, and challenging when it comes to applying version control.

Docker Compose provides a better experience than the Docker CLI. Instead of a command line, you work with YAML files that describe which containers you want to run and their characteristics. With Docker Compose, you can define all the applications and services composing your system in one place, and you can manage their life cycles together.

In this section, you'll configure the execution of the Catalog Service and PostgreSQL containers using Docker Compose. Then you'll learn how to debug a Spring Boot application running within a container.

If you have installed Docker Desktop for Mac or Docker Desktop for Windows, you already have Docker Compose installed. If you're on Linux, visit the Docker Compose installation page at www.docker.com and follow the instructions for your distribution. In any case, you can verify that Docker Compose is correctly installed by running the command `docker-compose --version`.

6.3.1 Using Docker Compose to manage the container life cycle

The Docker Compose syntax is very intuitive and self-explanatory. Often, it can be mapped one-to-one to Docker CLI arguments. The two root sections of a docker-compose.yml file are `version`, where you specify which syntax of Docker Compose you want to use, and `services`, containing the specifications for all the containers you want to run. Other optional root-level sections you may add are `volumes` and `networks`.